VIT Bhopal University

(VITYARTHI)

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Project Report

Digital Literacy Portfolio

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Introduction

This project report outlines the tasks undertaken for this project under the context of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. As part of this course, my role was to be a Student Digital Ambassador. A Student Digital Ambassador is a student representative who helps guide fellow students through the digital world.

The project comprises five different tasks, with each task being a part of a particular module of this course. These tasks include creating a digital literacy infographic, creating a professional online portfolio, learning about coding and collaboration tools, learning how to effectively use professional emails, and learning about cybercrime awareness. All of this has been put together in a GitHub repository.

This report outlines a written report for each of the tasks undertaken for this project, along with a reflection on the learning experience. No prior knowledge of coding was required for this project, and all tools used for this project are free and browser-based.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used:

Canva (canva.com) — a free, browser-based graphic design platform.

What the Design Shows:

For this task, I have designed a one-page infographic called "Navigate the Digital World" using Canva. The infographic is intended to assist first-year students in grasping the fundamental pillars of digital literacy in a concise manner. The infographic will include three main aspects of digital literacy:

- What Digital Literacy Is: This section will include a brief description of digital literacy and how it plays a vital role in today's digital world.
- Safe Internet Practices: This section will include some of the best internet safety practices, such as using passwords, avoiding suspicious URLs, using two-factor authentication, and so on.
- Professional Online Presence: This section will include a brief description of how it is important to maintain a clean and professional image on platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub as a student.

The infographic will include a combination of colors like blue and white, icons, bullet points, and bold text to make it easy to understand and look visually appealing.

Reflection

I chose Canva as it provides various infographic templates that can be easily edited even if you are not a graphic design expert. The biggest challenge I faced was deciding what to include in the infographic within a single page, as there is a lot to say regarding digital literacy. I chose to focus on the visual appeal of the infographic and kept it short and concise, which I think helped in creating a better infographic in the end. I have learned that it is not just what you include in the design but also what you exclude to make it better.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

For Platforms Set Up:

For this task, I have created and configured accounts for three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. All these platforms play a unique role in creating a digital identity.

- GitHub: GitHub is the world's largest platform for version control and collaborative software development. It is the most important platform for a CSE student like me, as it helps in showcasing my coding projects and skills to potential employers in the future. For my profile, I have created a README repository, which tells a little about me, like my name, branch, year, and what I hope to learn.

- LinkedIn: It is the world's largest professional networking website. It is used by employers, recruiters, and industry professionals. For my profile, I have filled in my educational details in the "Education" section, like my current degree, B.Tech in Computer Science Engineering, my current institution, VIT Bhopal University, and my expected year of graduation, 2029.

- Kaggle: It is a platform for data science and machine learning competitions, along with free courses, datasets, and notebooks. Though I am in my first year, creating an account here will help me in the future to explore the basics of data science, which is part of the CSE curriculum.

Future Plans:

In the coming four years, I plan to use GitHub to store all my academic and personal projects, which will be a great platform to store all my projects and showcase them to potential employers. On LinkedIn, I plan to fill in my skills, certifications, projects, and internship details, which will help me in creating a great profile by the end of my third year. On Kaggle, I plan to explore data science and machine learning, which is part of the CSE curriculum, and practice accordingly.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Part A – Coding Practice: HackerRank

For the coding practice, I chose HackerRank (hackerrank.com). HackerRank is one of the best coding practice sites, which is used by companies like Google, Amazon, and Microsoft to recruit candidates.

I registered on HackerRank and completed the "Solve Me First" challenge, which is an introductory problem designed to allow new users to become familiar with the submission process. The problem requires the user to read two integers from input and print their sum. This is an effective way to allow people to become familiar with an online judge. I also

attempted the Python Introduction challenge, which helps the user become familiar with Python syntax.

Part B – Google Workspace Collaboration: Google Forms

For the collaboration tool, I developed a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms. The quiz has five questions to assess whether the student has basic knowledge in digital literacy. The questions are:

- What does the term 'digital literacy' mean?
- Which of the following is a strong password?
- Name one platform you would use to showcase your coding projects.
- True or False: It is safe to click on links in emails from unknown senders.
- What does 2FA stand for, and why is it useful?

The form is linked to a Google Sheet, and all the answers are automatically recorded in the Google Sheet.

Reflection

I think these tools will be very useful to me in my academic journey. For example, HackerRank will be very useful in preparing for technical interviews and enhancing my problem-solving skills. Google Forms and Google Sheets are very useful tools for creating forms and quizzes, and knowing how to utilize them will be very helpful to me not just in my academic life, but in any working environment.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette

Communication Scenario

This poor digital communication could have severe implications in the real world. To illustrate this, if a student were to send a message to the professor in WhatsApp or any other platform that is written only in informal language, such as "sir plz pass me i need marks." This is not only rude and disrespectful but also lacks any form of explanation or greeting. The professor, who receives many such messages from other students, is not likely to take it seriously and might not even bother to reply. The student might then send a rude reply to the professor. This could have been handled in a much better way if the student had written a proper email that is well-structured and contains a proper subject line, greeting, explanation, and request. Professional communication is the key to ensuring that the other person knows that the matter is important and that the person is taking it seriously.

Key Learnings:

While working on this task, I have learned a number of things that are very important and that I will keep in mind in all my professional communications in the future. The subject line is more important than the email body. The tone is very difficult to set in text, and the words must be carefully chosen. A well-structured and concise email is always better than a long email that is not well-structured.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness: Phishing

What Surprised Me

During the process of researching this phenomenon of phishing, the most surprising fact I have come across is how sophisticated today's phishing attacks have become. No longer are they just misspelled emails from unknown sources; today's phishing attacks include perfect imitations of legitimate websites, personalized emails mentioning your actual name or university, and even voice calls, also called vishing, in which the caller pretends to be a bank representative or government official.

Another surprising fact I have come across during this research is that not only is this a problem faced by individuals, but it is also one of the biggest reasons for corporate data breaches across the globe. This goes to show that digital literacy and awareness are not just soft skills but are in fact critical skills that must be possessed by all professionals.

One Habit I Will Change

During this research, I have come to understand that the one habit I will change is to make it a point to verify the sender's email address carefully before clicking on any link in the email, especially if it is from my bank, college portal, or any website that requires me to enter my login credentials. I will also make it a point to enable two-factor authentication on all of my accounts, starting with my college email and GitHub, so that even if my password is compromised in the future, I will still be secure.

Conclusion:

The completion of this Digital Literacy Portfolio was a really valuable experience. I was somewhat aware of terms like cybersecurity, professional communication, and digital presence before this project, but working on every project systematically provided shape to these abstract ideas in my mind.

Creating my GitHub profile, LinkedIn profile, and Kaggle profile made me aware that creating a professional digital presence is a continuous process that requires early initiation. Creating an infographic made me aware that communication requires clarity and design thinking. Writing professional emails made me aware of how I project myself in digital form. This project is not just an academic project; it is a beginning to a digital portfolio that I will continue to enhance throughout my B.Tech course and beyond.

References

- Canva – Free Design Tool: https://www.canva.com
- GitHub – Version Control & Portfolio: https://www.github.com
- LinkedIn – Professional Networking: https://www.linkedin.com

- Kaggle – Data Science Platform: https://www.kaggle.com
- HackerRank – Coding Practice: https://www.hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – Survey & Quiz Tool: https://forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: https://www.cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930 (24x7, India)
- CERT-In (Indian Computer Emergency Response Team): https://www.cert-in.org.in